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CARIBBEAN EXAMINATIONS COUNCIL

SECONDARY EDUCATION CERTIFICATE EXAMINATION

ENGLISH A

Paper 02 – General Proficiency

$2\frac{1}{2}$ hours

19 MAY 2009 (a.m.)

Candidates are allowed 10 minutes to read through the paper before starting to write. This 10-minute period is in addition to the $2\frac{1}{2}$ hours allowed for the examination.

Candidates MAY write during the time allowed for reading through the paper.

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

1. Section A consists of **ONE** question. Candidates MUST answer this question.
2. Section B consists of **TWO** questions. Candidates MUST answer both questions from this section.
3. Section C consists of **THREE** questions. Candidates MUST answer **ONE** question from this section.
4. Section D consists of **TWO** questions. Candidates MUST answer **ONE** question from this section.

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SECTION A

(Suggested time: 35 minutes)

Answer Question 1.

1. **Read the following extract carefully and then write a summary of it in NOT MORE THAN 120 words and, as far as possible, in your OWN words. Your summary must be in continuous prose and in paragraph form. If this limit is exceeded, only the first 120 words of your answer will be read and assessed.**

Although some Caribbean states went out of cane production many years ago, for the most part, the industry has flourished and sugar has remained the English-speaking Caribbean's premier export crop buoyed by high prices and preferential trading arrangements first with the United Kingdom and then with the European Community.

More recently, some sugar industries in the Caribbean have proved unviable as much larger global producers such as Brazil and Australia have begun to export and world market prices have declined. In response, in some of the region's economies newer industries such as tourism have enabled Caribbean economies to diversify.

Despite this, sugar still plays a key role. In Jamaica, as many as 200 000 people (about 8% of the Jamaican population of 2.6 million) derive their livelihood directly or indirectly from the sugar industry. Sugar cane is grown in almost every single parish and nearly half of the land under permanent agricultural crops is in sugar cane. The industry also makes a vital contribution to Jamaica's foreign exchange earnings bringing in excess of US$100 million each year in foreign exchange. Beyond this, sugar plays a significant role in maintaining rural environment. The planting of cane protects the soil from erosion and creates a habitat in which a wide range of Jamaican fauna is able to flourish.

Now much of this has to change. The decision by Europe to cut its preferential price over a three-year period as a result of a World Trade Organization ruling has led industries across the region to review their viability. Some such as St. Kitts have decided to move out of the production of raw sugar for export altogether. Others like Barbados are looking at adding value to their small industry through marketing of organic and branded speciality sugars.

Achieving the economies of scale that this transition requires will be far from easy. It will require all the European support that has been promised and more. It will involve a significant investment in the modernization of the industry as well as the retraining of some personnel to enable them to migrate to other forms of agriculture or to the region's fast expanding tourism sector.

Adapted from David Jessop, "The bitter taste of sugar".
Skywritings, May/June 2006, pp. 36–37.

Total 30 marks

SECTION B

(Suggested time: 40 minutes)

Answer Questions 2 and 3.

2. Read the passage below carefully and then answer all the questions that follow.

It was six o'clock on Friday evening, about fifteen years after Rose's departure, and exactly a fortnight since her return. Mother Barton lay supine on the bed. The counterpane was drawn up to the neck leaving her heels and toes exposed at the other end. Her eyelashes were damp and she squinted continually. The lingering stains of witch-hazel had given her cheeks a quiet subdued warmth. Her sight had improved and now she seemed perfectly happy.

The door of her room opened and Angela entered on tiptoe. She kissed her on her eyes, squeezing her hand, and pressing her mouth to her ear whispered something. Mother Barton came to a sitting position, and peering from half-shut eyes spat out her disapproval into Angela's face. Angela protested. Mother Barton was violent in her insistence. She refused to act against her will. The conflict proceeded into a crescendo of gasps and whispers. Angela persuaded. Mother Barton rebuked. Their patience was at an end, and Angela in a fever of indignation flung the door open and summoned Rose to the room. Mother Barton lay back quietly, her lids pressed to her eyes, her hand locked across her breast. Rose entered, and knelt beside the bed, remembering for a split second that it was their second reunion.

Angela left the room, and for a while Mother Barton felt empty and dejected. It was seldom that Angela displeased her, but to-day she seemed unbearably callous. In spite of all that happened she had insisted on seeing Rose again, and now she and Rose, whom she thought so hateful and wretched, were in the same room. If she were young and strong she would have avenged herself, but now she could only lie and think and hate. No word was spoken until Mother Barton craned her body up, and groped about the room.

George Lamming, "Of thorns and thistles".
West Indian Stories, pp. 48–49.

(a) What did Angela do that indicates that she did not want to disturb Mother Barton too much? **(2 marks)**

(b) What effect does the use of short sentences in the middle of paragraph 2 have? **(2 marks)**

(c) What was Mother Barton's normal attitude to Angela? **(1 mark)**

(d) What kind of atmosphere existed in Mother Barton's bedroom? **(2 marks)**

(e) What did Mother Barton think of what Angela whispered in her ears? **(2 marks)**

(f) What does the author suggest about Mother Barton by describing her change of posture in lines 13 - 14? **(2 marks)**

(g) Why was Mother Barton unable to avenge herself (line 20)? **(2 marks)**

(h) What do the phrases "squinted continually" (line 4), "peering from half-shut eyes" (line 8), "groped about the room" (line 21) tell us about Mother Barton? **(2 marks)**

Total 15 marks

3. Read the passage below carefully and then answer all the questions that follow.

Just when many people thought the question of what to do about the ten to twelve million undocumented immigrants in the United States was the only item on the table for discussion, we have been jolted back to reality to deal with a long-standing problem: immigrants who commit crimes in the United States and are being deported to the various Caribbean nations.

Understandably, the United States, Canada and Britain are angry that immigrants would come to their shores and commit crimes. The trouble is that in deporting immigrants, the rich nations are creating serious problems for their relatively poor "friends" in the Caribbean.

According to a regional news agency report, a United States Ambassador in the region is convinced that criminal aliens are not behind much of the crime in the Caribbean. Granted, some deportees have become productive citizens. Also true, the United States has the right to protect its people from anyone, native born or foreigner, who disrupts society. But to ignore the hard reality of what's happening in the Caribbean is akin to burying one's head in the proverbial sand. After all, choirboys are not being shipped to the region from the United States.

In addition, the Ambassador wants to get the word out that the United States was "not deporting people who go to the United States as very small children and learn bad behaviour". But the evidence indicates otherwise. Many of the deportees left the region as underage children and were sent back to the Caribbean as hardened adult criminals. Just as bad, they had lived in the United States for so long that they do not know anyone in the Caribbean and few know them.

The solution isn't difficult to figure out. The countries sending back the criminals and those being forced to accept them should sit down and work out a reasonable policy that includes a resettlement scheme funded by the United States, Canada, Britain and the Caribbean nations that would ease the re-integration of the deportees into their birthplaces.

Adapted from Tony Best, "Impact of Criminal Aliens".
Weekend Nation, May 12, 2006, p. 24.

(a) What are the TWO categories of immigrants that are referred to in paragraph 1? **(2 marks)**

(b) What is the effect of the word "jolted" (line 3)? **(2 marks)**

(c) What is meant by "burying one's head in the proverbial sand" (lines 14 - 15) in the context of this passage? **(2 marks)**

(d) What effect is the writer trying to create by using the word "understandably" (line 6)? **(2 marks)**

(e) What is the significance of putting "friends" (line 8) in inverted commas? **(1 mark)**

(f) Give ONE example of sarcasm in paragraph 3. **(2 marks)**

(g) What evidence is the writer referring to in paragraph 4 that is contrary to the Ambassador's position? **(2 marks)**

(h) What solution is the writer proposing for the problem of deportees? **(2 marks)**

Total 15 marks

SECTION C

(Suggested time: 45 minutes)

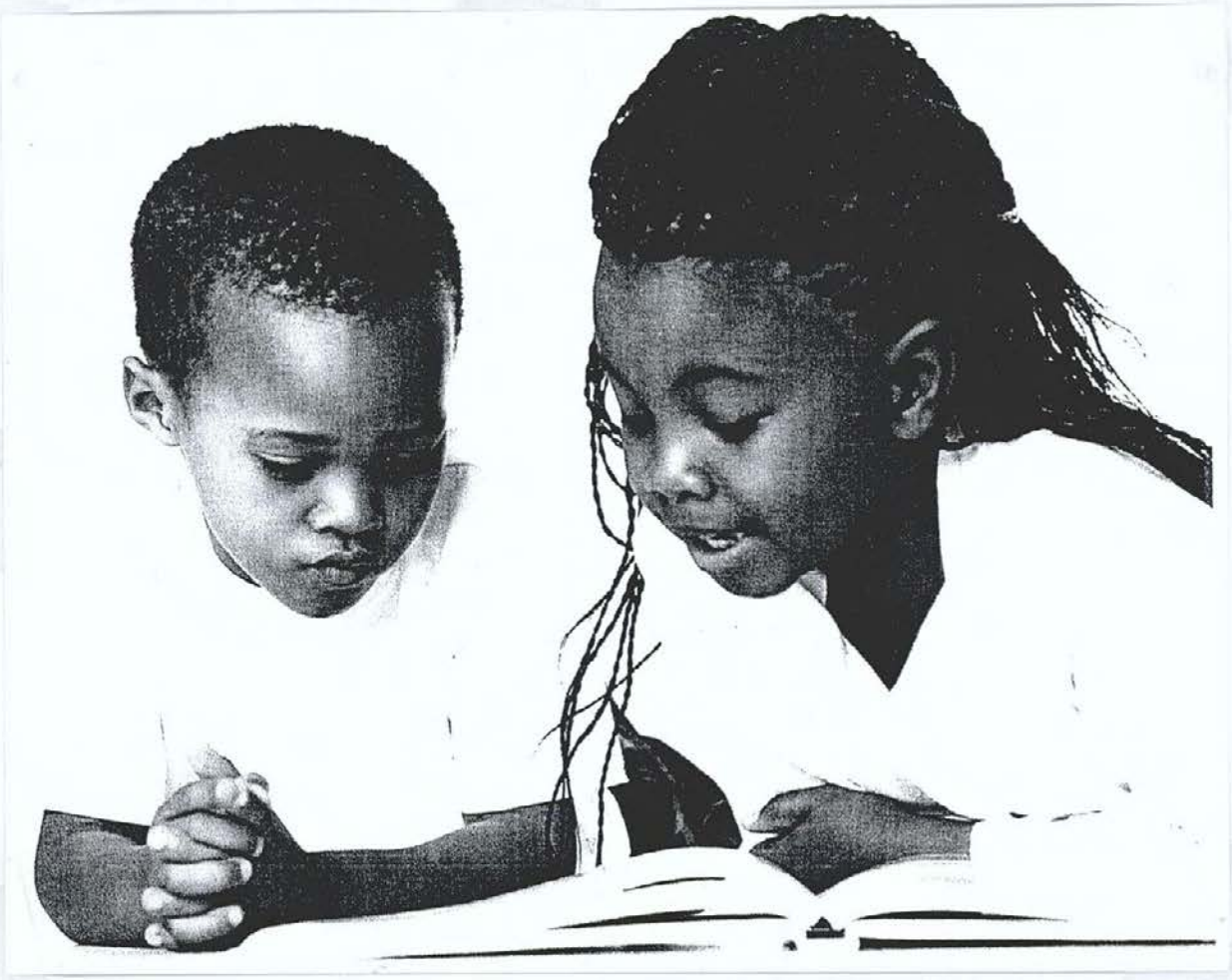
Answer ONE question in this section.

Your answer in this section should be approximately 400 to 450 words in length.

You MUST write in Standard English. However, dialect may be used in conversation.

SHORT STORY (Questions 4 and 5)

4. Write a story based on the picture below.



STAN, UWI St Augustine, October – December 2007.

(35 marks)

OR

5. The door was closed and the cobwebs in front of it suggested it had not been opened for a long time. Moor turned the key and pushed open the door.

Write a story which includes this sentence. **(35 marks)**

DESCRIPTION (Question 6)

6. We set out on the hike to Cassanda and we did not bargain for the terrible weather.

Describe the places along the route and the ways in which the weather affected the hike.

(35 marks)

SECTION D

(Suggested time: 30 minutes)

Answer ONE question in this section.

Your answer in this section should be approximately 250 to 300 words in length.

You MUST write in Standard English.

EITHER

7. Watching television, rather than reading, is the best way for children to broaden their knowledge.

Write an essay giving your views on this statement. **(35 marks)**

OR

8. The government is wasting too much money buying school textbooks because the children are not reading them. More money should be spent on computer equipment, which children prefer.

Write an essay EITHER supporting OR opposing this view. **(35 marks)**

END OF TEST

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